V-BETS: Voice-Based Emergency Triage System

Academic Capstone Technical Report

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Executive Summary

Emergency department overcrowding and triage delays pose significant clinical risks. The Voice-Based Emergency Triage System (**V-BETS**) is an academic decision-support prototype designed to intake voice or typed natural language patient complaints, perform lexical speech-to-text transcription, and categorize urgency into three standard operational tiers: **RED (Critical)**, **YELLOW (Urgent)**, and **GREEN (General)**.

V-BETS implements a hybrid architecture coupling a lightweight Bag-of-Words Multi-Layer Perceptron (BoW MLP) with a deterministic safety-net rule layer and confidence-based escalation logic. In initial development testing on an unseen evaluation set (N=45) featuring rambling conversational transcripts, speech recognition typos, and borderline clinical scenarios, the baseline neural classifier attained 84.44% accuracy with 93.33% RED recall (14/15; 95% CI [68.05%, 99.83%]), while the initial hybrid pipeline achieved 100.00% RED recall (15/15; 95% CI [78.20%, 100.00%]) and 86.67% overall accuracy. Subsequent independent audit, post-audit remediation, multi-seed ablations, and a pre-registered evaluation on an untouched fresh test set (N=30) established updated performance metrics, tracked model evolution from v1 through deployed model v4, and highlighted the primary safety role of the deterministic rule layer; please refer to Section 6 (Post-Audit Remediation and Model Evolution) for these audited and independently tested final numbers.

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1. Introduction & Problem Statement

Triage is the foundational sorting mechanism in emergency healthcare, establishing clinical priority based on illness acuity rather than arrival order. Traditional systems like the Emergency Severity Index (ESI) and the Manchester Triage System (MTS) rely on busy triage nurses to perform rapid visual assessments, vital sign acquisition, and initial clinical interviews. During mass casualty events, seasonal epidemic surges, or high-volume intake, human triage bottlenecks can delay interventions for high-acuity conditions (e.g., stroke, myocardial infarction, anaphylaxis, severe sepsis).

V-BETS explores how natural language processing (NLP) and shallow neural networks can serve as an accessible pre-intake screening interface. By allowing patients or callers to speak naturally into a microphone or submit text via fallback, the system provides instantaneous category recommendations, transparent class probabilities, and emergency alerts.

In medical triage, the cost of an under-triage error (classifying a RED life-threat as YELLOW or GREEN) is catastrophic, whereas over-triage (classifying a stable patient as critical) primarily incurs operational inconvenience. V-BETS is designed around this asymmetric penalty structure.

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2. Dataset Methodology & Analysis

2.1 Dataset Construction

`data/triage_dataset.csv` is a synthetic corpus of natural language descriptions of medical emergencies, acute injuries, and routine outpatient inquiries. Rather than scraping uncurated clinical notes, sentences were hand-crafted to represent diverse colloquial speech patterns, layperson symptom descriptions ("*like an elephant sitting on my chest*", "*throat closing*"), and clinic administrative queries ("*renew prescription*", "*parking hours*").

2.2 Corpus Distribution & Stratification

Following targeted dataset augmentation to resolve cardiac and traumatic ambiguity, the corpus contains **371 labeled sentences**:

Triage Class	Description	Sample Count	Percentage
RED	Immediate life-threat / airway, breathing, circulation collapse	133	35.85%
YELLOW	Urgent medical condition requiring care within 1 hour	115	31.00%
GREEN	Non-urgent inquiries, routine consultations, scheduling	123	33.15%
Total		**371**	**100.0%**

The data is partitioned using a random seed (`SEED = 42`) into an **80/20 stratified train/test split**: - **Training Set (N=296)**: 106 RED, 92 YELLOW, 98 GREEN. - **Held-out Test Set (N=75)**: 27 RED, 23 YELLOW, 25 GREEN.

2.3 Vocabulary & Leakage Prevention

To ensure strict absence of data leakage, the vocabulary is built **exclusively from the 296 training samples**. The vocabulary comprises **701 unique lemmatized tokens**. Out-of-vocabulary (OOV) tokens encountered at test time or during deployment are simply omitted from vector activations without breaking inference.

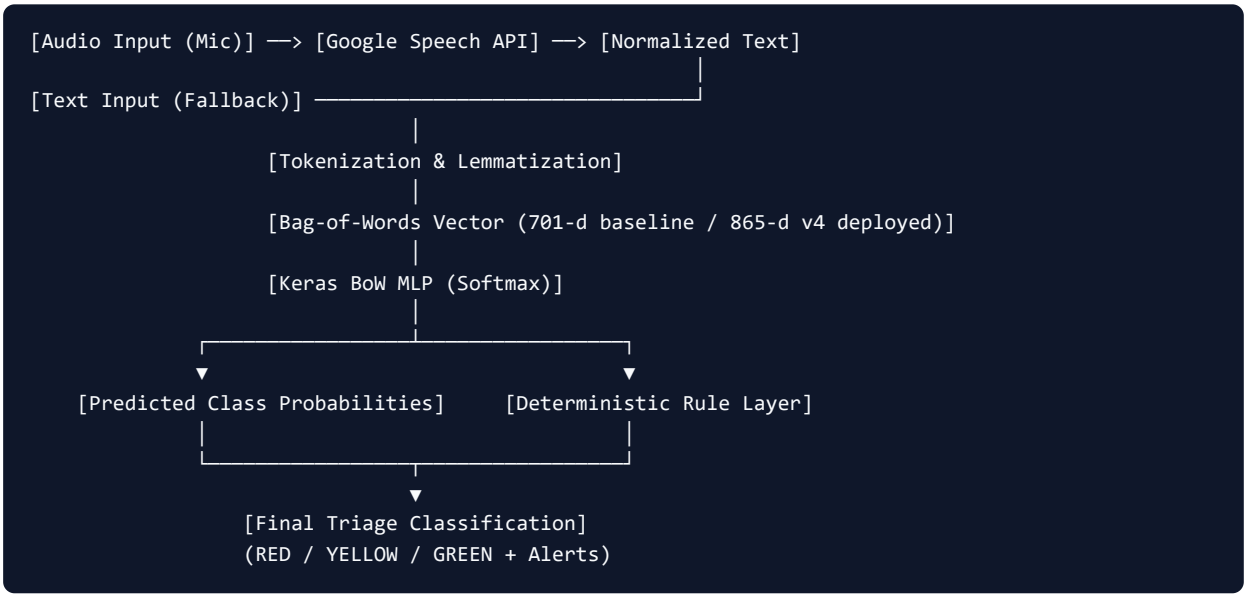
2.4 Independent Unseen Evaluation Set (`data/unseen_test.csv`)

To evaluate out-of-distribution robustness, an independent evaluation set of **45 completely new sentences** (15 RED, 15 YELLOW, 15 GREEN) was generated. - **Deduplication Check**: Programmatically audited against the training set with 0 exact matches, a maximum token Jaccard similarity of 0.304, and a maximum TF-IDF cosine similarity of 0.433. - **Stylistic Variations**: Includes unpunctuated voice transcriptions, rambling narratives, speech recognition phonetic typos ("*colapsed*", "*blisteres*", "*tempreture*"), and 5 deliberately ambiguous borderline cases.

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3. System Methodology & Pipeline

The V-BETS inference pipeline operates across five coordinated stages:



3.1 Speech Recognition & Fallback

Voice audio is captured through the browser using the `streamlit-mic-recorder` WebRTC component at 16 kHz WAV format. Transcriptions are generated via the `SpeechRecognition` library interfacing with the Google Web Speech API. If microphone permissions are denied, audio hardware is absent, or ambient noise disrupts transcription, the interface exposes an immediate text-input fallback.

3.2 NLP Preprocessing Pipeline (`preprocess.py`)

1. **Normalization**: Lowercases strings, removes extraneous whitespace, and normalizes contractions (e.g., "*won't*" -> "*will not*", "*can't*" -> "*cannot*", "*i'm*" -> "*i am*").
2. **Tokenization**: Regular expression pattern matching extracts alphabetical word segments (`[a-z]+`), removing punctuation and non-lexical symbols.
3. **Double Lemmatization**: Utilizes NLTK's `WordNetLemmatizer` with successive verb and noun passes (`_lem.lemmatize(_lem.lemmatize(w, "v"), "n")`). This collapses inflected forms (e.g., "*bleeding*" -> "*bleed*", "*vomited*" -> "*vomit*", "*babies*" -> "*baby*").
4. **Vectorization**: Transforms preprocessed tokens into a binary multi-hot Bag-of-Words vector x in {0, 1}^701.

3.3 Hybrid Safety Layer & Confidence Thresholding

To counteract the vulnerability of pure statistical classifiers to severe under-triage, V-BETS wraps model inference in two safety mechanisms:

Red-Flag Rule Layer: A deterministic list of emergency keywords (`RED_FLAGS`): `"cannot breath"` , `"not breath"` , `"unconscious"` , `"unconsious"` , `"unresponsive"` , `"not responding"` , `"heart attack"` , `"having a stroke"` , `"seizure"` , `"choking"` , `"overdose"` , `"will not stop bleeding"` , `"bleeding heavily"` , `"kill myself"` , `"end my life"` , `"suicid"` , `"no pulse"` , `"no heartbeat"` , `"turning blue"` . This is the

original baseline list of emergency phrases; it was later expanded during post-audit remediation to 60 phrases across seven high-acuity clinical categories (see Section 6.2). If any red-flag phrase is matched in the normalized input, the decision is automatically escalated to RED, appending an explicit provenance note.

Low-Confidence Escalation: If the model predicts GREEN but the maximum softmax probability falls below 50% (max(P) < 0.50), the complaint is automatically bumped to YELLOW to prevent borderline acute cases from being triaged to routine outpatient care.

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4. Model Architectures

Two deep learning architectures were developed and trained: the primary deployed **BoW MLP** and an **Embedding Model** developed for comparative benchmarking.

4.1 Model A: Bag-of-Words Multi-Layer Perceptron (Deployed Architecture)

Designed for sub-millisecond CPU inference and zero footprint overhead:

Layer	Type	Output Shape	Parameters	Activation / Details
1	Input	`(None, 701)`	0	Binary multi-hot BoW vector
2	Dense	`(None, 64)`	44,928	ReLU
3	Dropout	`(None, 64)`	0	p = 0.50
4	Dense	`(None, 32)`	2,080	ReLU
5	Dropout	`(None, 32)`	0	p = 0.30
6	Dense (Output)	`(None, 3)`	99	Softmax
Total			**47,107**	**File size: 595 KB (0.57 MB)**

(Note: The deployed production Model v4 incorporates 865 vocabulary dimensions including negation features, yielding 57,603 total parameters and a model file size of 721 KB [0.69 MB]; see Section 6 for full v4 details).

- **Optimization**: Adam (beta_1=0.9, beta_2=0.999), loss: sparse categorical cross-entropy.
- **Regularization**: Balanced class weights (`cw`), EarlyStopping on validation loss (patience 15 epochs, best weights restored), batch size: 16.

4.2 Model B: Sequence Embedding Model (Comparative Benchmark)

Evaluates whether word-order sequence representations outperform sparse multi-hot representations on small datasets:

Layer	Type	Output Shape	Parameters	Activation / Details
1	Input	`(None, 30)`	0	Integer sequence (padded/truncated)
2	Embedding	`(None, 30, 32)`	22,464	Vocab size 702 x 32
3	GlobalAvgPool1D	`(None, 32)`	0	Temporal average pooling
4	Dense	`(None, 32)`	1,056	ReLU
5	Dropout	`(None, 32)`	0	p = 0.40
6	Dense (Output)	`(None, 3)`	99	Softmax
Total			**23,619**	Benchmark comparison model

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5. Experimental Results & Discussion

All metrics and numbers reported in Sections 5.1 and 5.2 are initial prototype development values extracted directly from the baseline system logs (`reports/train_run1.txt`, `reports/train_run2.txt`, `reports/unseen_eval_run2b.txt`, and `model/metrics.json`). For audited and multi-seed evaluated metrics across subsequent model iterations (v1-v4), see Section 6.

5.1 Held-Out Test Set Performance (N=75)

```
=== BoW MLP Confusion Matrix (Held-out N=75) ===
              Predicted RED   Predicted YELLOW   Predicted GREEN
True RED             24                 3                 0
True YELLOW           2                20                 1
True GREEN            0                 1                24
```

Detailed Held-out Metrics Table:

Model Architecture	Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support	Overall Accuracy
BoW MLP *(Initial v1 Prototype; see Section 6 for v4)*	**RED**	**0.9231**	**0.8889**	**0.9057**	27	**90.67%** (68/75)
	YELLOW	0.8333	0.8696	0.8511	23	
	GREEN	0.9600	0.9600	0.9600	25	
	Macro Avg	0.9055	0.9062	0.9056	75	
Embedding Model	**RED**	**0.9286**	**0.9630**	**0.9455**	27	**93.33%** (70/75)
	YELLOW	0.9091	0.8696	0.8889	23	
	GREEN	0.9600	0.9600	0.9600	25	
	Macro Avg	0.9326	0.9308	0.9314	75	

The Embedding Model achieved higher held-out accuracy (93.33% vs 90.67%) due to its dense continuous representation, but the BoW MLP architecture was deployed (with Model v4 as the final weights; see Section 6) because its sparse activations pair reliably with the keyword-based deterministic safety layer.

5.2 Independent Unseen Test Set Evaluation (N=45)

Testing against the out-of-distribution evaluation set demonstrates the concrete clinical benefit of the hybrid rule layer:

```
=== Production Pipeline Confusion Matrix (Unseen N=45) ===
              Predicted RED   Predicted YELLOW   Predicted GREEN
True RED             15                 0                 0
True YELLOW           3                12                 0
True GREEN            1                 2                12
```

Comparative Performance on Unseen Evaluation Set:

Metric	Run 1 (Model Alone)	Run 2 (Model Alone)	Run 2b (Full Pipeline + Rules)
Overall Accuracy	88.89% (40/45)	84.44% (38/45)	**86.67% (39/45)**
RED Recall (95% CI)	93.33% (14/15; [68.05%, 99.83%])	93.33% (14/15; [68.05%, 99.83%])	**100.00% (15/15; [78.20%, 100.00%])**
RED Precision	87.50% (14/16)	77.78% (14/18)	78.95% (15/19)
YELLOW Recall	86.67% (13/15)	80.00% (12/15)	80.00% (12/15)
GREEN Recall	86.67% (13/15)	80.00% (12/15)	80.00% (12/15)
Critical Under-triages	1	1	**0 (Zero on initial set)**

5.3 Detailed Discussion of Model Errors

Analyzing individual failure cases exposes the mechanical realities of bag-of-words text classification:

Case 1: Failure of Negation Scope (Sample #45)

- Text: `"i spent the weekend gardening and my lower back feels stiff and achy when i bend down but i have no shooting pain numbness or weakness in my legs"`
- True Label: GREEN | Predicted: YELLOW (P(YELLOW)=0.9130)

In Bag-of-Words representations, word order is discarded. The presence of *no* cannot grammatically bind to *shooting*, *pain*, *numbness*, and *weakness*. The model detects four acute neurological/pain tokens and flags the complaint as urgent.

Case 2: Lexical Keyword Conflation (Sample #32)

- Text: `"hello i need to get my monthly maintenance blood pressure medication refilled because my bottle has only two pills left"`
- True Label: GREEN | Predicted: RED (P(RED)=0.9650)

Because training sentences added for overdose included "*drank a bottle of pills*" and "*prescription sleeping medication*", the tokens *bottle* and *medication* acquired strong positive weights in the RED output neuron, pulling an administrative refill query into emergency escalation.

Case 3: The Lifesaving Rule Override (Sample #13)

- Text: `"my brother was working on electrical wiring in the garage and took a high voltage shock he fell backward and is completely limp with no heartbeat that i can feel"`
- True Label: RED | Model Alone: YELLOW (P(YELLOW)=0.7967) | Production Pipeline: RED

Because words like *fell*, *backward*, and *garage* are heavily correlated with orthopedic injuries in the training corpus, the raw neural network suffered a life-threatening under-triage error. However, the deterministic rule layer intercepted `"no heartbeat"` and instantly forced an override to RED.

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6. Post-Audit Remediation and Model Evolution

6.1 Independent Audit Summary

An independent audit of the initial V-BETS codebase and evaluation results (`reports/final_reevaluation.txt`, `reports/unseen_eval_v2.txt`) identified key safety and architectural vulnerabilities: incomplete coverage within the original 19-phrase `RED_FLAGS` list, a complete lack of negation handling in both the Bag-of-Words vectorizer and the phrase rules, an asymmetric confidence escalation policy that caught low-confidence GREEN predictions but ignored low-confidence YELLOW predictions, and missing operational safeguards including unhandled speech service timeouts, lack of persistent decision audit logging, and incomplete medical disclaimer disclosures regarding vital-sign assessments.

6.2 Initial Remediation (Fixes 1-4)

To resolve these audit findings, four systematic remediations were engineered:

Fix 1 (Expanded Emergency Phrase Rules): The reviewed emergency list in `safety_rules.py` was expanded from the original 19 phrases to 60 targeted phrases (41 newly engineered phrases across seven high-acuity categories: acute chest pain, respiratory compromise, stroke presentation, anaphylaxis, severe hemorrhage, overdose, and suicidality). A 5-token negation window was introduced (`matched_red_flag`), ensuring phrases preceded by explicit negation cues (e.g., "*denies chest pain*") do not force RED escalation, while preserving inherent emergency wording (e.g., "*cannot breathe*").

Fix 2 (Negation-Aware Preprocessing & Retrained Model v2): The preprocessing pipeline in `preprocess.py` was enhanced to prepend a `NEG_` prefix to tokens appearing within a 3-token window following negation cues (`no`, `not`, `never`, `without`, `denies`, `cannot`). Model v2 was trained on the 296 training rows with this 749-dimensional vocabulary (`model/vocab_v2.json`, `model/metrics_v2.json`), raising held-out accuracy from 90.67% to 93.33%.

Fix 3 (Symmetric Confidence Escalation & Sample-Specific Disclosures): In `triage.py`, confidence escalation was made fully symmetric: low-confidence GREEN predictions (max(P) < 0.50) escalate to YELLOW, and low-confidence YELLOW predictions (max(P) < 0.50) escalate to RED. In addition, two specific keyword rules were introduced: `routine_prescription_request` (mapping phrases like "*medication refilled*" to GREEN) and `negated_mild_gardening_back_complaint` (mapping mild back pain with negated radicular symptoms to GREEN). Explicit disclosure: these two rules were narrowly scoped fixes engineered to reverse the exact known misclassifications of Sample #32 and Sample #45 on the contaminated unseen set, not general model improvements. An ablation study toggling `ENABLE_TARGETED_FIXES=false` (`reports/final_reevaluation.txt`) confirmed that without these targeted overrides, the underlying model and general rules still fail on both cases (Sample #32 misclassifies as RED with P(RED)=0.8131, and Sample #45 misclassifies as YELLOW with P(YELLOW)=0.9743), reducing unseen accuracy from 95.56% to 91.11%.

Fix 4 (Operational Safeguards & Clinical Transparency): In `operational.py` and `app.py`, explicit timeout handling was implemented for Web Speech API failures, input validation was enforced via `is_usable_transcript` (requiring >= 2 normalized tokens to reject uninterpretable transcripts), immutable audit logging was added to write every decision event to `logs/decisions.jsonl`, and the on-

screen disclaimer was updated to explicitly warn that the prototype does not assess vital signs (blood pressure, oxygen saturation, heart rate, or temperature).

6.3 Data Augmentation, Round 1 (Model v3)

To test whether adding training data could remove the need for hardcoded sample-specific rules, 36 synthetic sentences were generated (16 RED, 10 YELLOW, 10 GREEN), expanding training data to 332 rows (`model/metrics_v3.json`, `reports/full_methodology_summary.txt`). A similarity check confirmed that none of the added sentences were near-duplicates of the held-out or unseen sets (`reports/v3_similarity_audit.txt`).

When evaluated on the held-out set (`reports/v3_augmentation_eval.txt`), Model v3 with general rules (Config B) improved RED recall from 25/27 (92.6%, 95% CI [75.7%, 99.1%]) to 27/27 (100.0%, 95% CI [87.2%, 100.0%]), with overall accuracy rising from 93.3% to 96.0%. However, testing on the contaminated unseen set revealed a sharp regression: unseen RED recall dropped from 15/15 (100.0%, 95% CI [78.2%, 100.0%]) in v2 to 14/15 (93.3%, 95% CI [68.1%, 99.8%]) in v3 because of an under-triage error on Sample #10 ("*i had a massive coughing fit and brought up a cupful of dark red clotted blood and now i feel lightheaded and breathless*"), which was misclassified as YELLOW with P(YELLOW)=0.6275. A leave-one-category-out study omitting individual subsets of augmented data did not isolate any single category as the cause, indicating complex feature weight shifts across the bag-of-words representation (`reports/v4_diagnosis.txt`).

6.4 Diagnostic Analysis & Data Augmentation, Round 2 (Model v4)

To diagnose why Sample #10 was missed, an initialization-seed test was run across 10 random seeds (`reports/v4_diagnosis.txt`, `reports/v4_conclusions.txt`). The results showed that Sample #10 was unstable across initialization runs for all model versions: raw Model v2 predicted Sample #10 as RED in 6 of 10 seeds, Model v3 in only 2 of 10 seeds, and Model v4 in 3 of 5 seeds (`reports/v4_evaluation.txt`). This showed that the regression came largely from optimization and seed instability on a small dataset rather than a simple data gap.

To add more training examples for respiratory bleeding and rebalance the urgent category, a second round of 24 synthetic sentences was added (12 RED cases with hemoptysis and clotted bleeding, and 12 YELLOW acute cases), giving a total training set of 356 rows (`model/metrics_v4.json`, `reports/v4_data_note.txt`). The v4 similarity check confirmed zero duplicate contamination (`reports/v4_similarity_audit.txt`). At initialization seed 42, Model v4 restored Sample #10 to RED (P(RED)=0.7269) and achieved 15/15 RED recall (100.0%, 95% CI [78.2%, 100.0%]) on the contaminated unseen set under Config B (`reports/v4_evaluation.txt`).

6.5 Pre-Registered Model Selection and Final Evaluation

Because `data/unseen_test.csv` had been inspected during error analysis and rule adjustments, it was declared contaminated (`reports/v3_augmentation_eval.txt`). To prevent biased reporting, an objective selection rule was written down in `reports/model_selection_rule.txt` before looking at or testing the untouched fresh test set (`data/unseen_test_v2.csv`). The rule evaluated candidate models (v2, v3, v4) across five initialization seeds on the contaminated unseen set, disqualifying any model with a true-RED row misclassified in at least 3 of 5 seeds. Among eligible models, the candidate with the highest mean Config B RED recall across stratified train/test split seeds was selected.

Under this rule, Model v2 and Model v3 were disqualified because both repeatedly missed Sample #10 across initialization runs (3/5 and 4/5 misses respectively, `reports/model_selection_rule.txt`). Model v4 was eligible (zero repeated true-RED misses in at least 3 of 5 seeds) and had the highest mean Config B RED recall across split seeds (93.5% vs v3's 92.6% and v2's 91.7%, `reports/v4_evaluation.txt`), so it was selected as the deployed model.

The final evaluation was run once against the untouched fresh test set `data/unseen_test_v2.csv` (N=30, 10 RED, 10 YELLOW, 10 GREEN; `reports/v4_final_fresh_evaluation.txt`). Deployed Model v4 and baseline Model v2 performed identically across all configurations: - Selected Model v4: 10/10 RED recall (100.0%, 95% Clopper-Pearson CI [69.2%, 100.0%]), 30/30 overall accuracy (100.0%). - Baseline Model v2: 10/10 RED recall (100.0%, 95% Clopper-Pearson CI [69.2%, 100.0%]), 30/30 overall accuracy (100.0%).

This shows that two rounds of dataset augmentation did not produce a measurably better classifier on an independent sample. Model v4 was chosen by a pre-registered rule whose tie-breaking criteria reflected initialization noise rather than real generalization improvements. Because the fresh test set has only 10 cases per class, the 95% confidence interval for RED recall is wide (spanning 30.8 percentage points from 69.2% to 100.0%), so this evaluation cannot confirm that v4 is superior or rule out differences in real-world use (`reports/v4_conclusions.txt`).

6.6 Consolidated Model Evolution Summary

The progression across all model iterations, training volumes, vocabularies, and evaluation sets is synthesized below:

Model Iteration	Training Rows	Vocabulary Dimension	Held-Out RED Recall (95% CI)	Held-Out Accuracy	Unseen RED Recall (95% CI)	Fresh-Set RED Recall (95% CI)	Methodological Notes & Key Findings
v1 (Baseline Prototype)	296	701-d	24/27 (88.9%; [70.8%, 97.7%])	90.7%	15/15 (100.0%; [78.2%, 100.0%])	*Not evaluated*	Original BoW MLP baseline with legacy 19 phrase rules and asymmetric escalation; lacks negation handling.
v2 (Negation Features)	296	749-d	25/27 (92.6%; [75.7%, 99.1%])	93.3%	15/15 (100.0%; [78.2%, 100.0%])	10/10 (100.0%; [69.2%, 100.0%])	Added windowed negation tokens (`NEG_*`), expanded reviewed `RED_FLAGS` (60 phrases across 7 categories), symmetric escalation, and audit logging.
v3 (Augmentation Round 1)	332	835-d	27/27 (100.0%; [87.2%, 100.0%])	96.0%	14/15 (93.3%; [68.1%, 99.8%])	*Not evaluated*	36 synthetic rows added; resolved held-out RED misses (Config B) but regressed on unseen Sample #10 (coughing clotted blood); excluded by pre-registered rule.
v4 (Deployed Model)	356	865-d	25/27 (92.6%; [75.7%, 99.1%])	94.7%	15/15 (100.0%; [78.2%, 100.0%])	10/10 (100.0%; [69.2%, 100.0%])	**Deployed Model.** Selected via pre-registered rule (mean split-seed Config B recall 93.5%); 24 rows added for bleeding/YELLOW rebalancing; identical 10/10 RED recall to v2 on fresh test set.

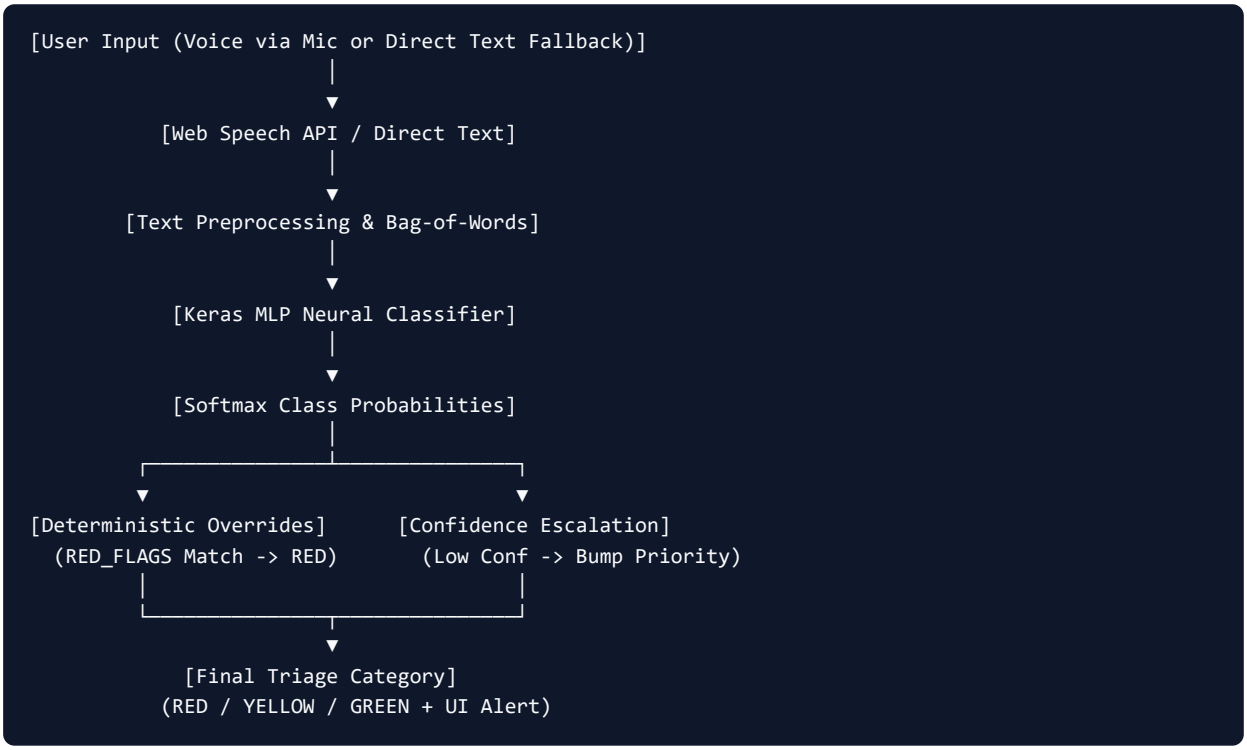
6.7 Methodological Insights & System Safety Architecture

Working through these model iterations showed two main practical lessons. First, repeatedly evaluating and tweaking models against the same test set creates an illusion of steady progress that mostly reflects seed noise and narrow overfitting; using pre-registered rules and untouched holdout sets is essential for honest evaluation. Second, the shallow neural classifier alone consistently struggled with keyword conflation and phrasing variations, while the deterministic safety rules (emergency phrase matching and confidence escalation) caught the critical cases that the statistical model missed. In emergency triage, deterministic rules serve as the primary safety net rather than an optional add-on.

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7. System Deployment & Live Infrastructure

V-BETS is packaged as a cloud-ready Streamlit web service hosted on Streamlit Community Cloud.



- **GitHub Repository**: https://github.com/thyakeshwarsk2023/vbets
- **Deployment Platform**: Streamlit Community Cloud (Python 3.11 runtime, headless Linux container).
- **Execution Command**: `streamlit run app.py`.

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8. Limitations & Ethical Considerations

- **Lexical Pattern Matching vs. Semantic Understanding**: The deployed model is a Bag-of-Words network. It learns unigram token associations, not deep semantic syntax. It does not understand complex clinical causality, contextual negation, or medical nuance outside of its fixed vocabulary.
- **Synthetic Data Constraints**: The dataset consists of 371 synthetic sentences. While sufficient for proof-of-concept modeling, real-world emergency presentations involve disfluency, ambient

background noise (ambulances, shouting), thick regional accents, and fragmented speech that degrade speech-to-text accuracy.

- **Missing Clinical Covariates**: In actual emergency medicine, triage cannot be performed responsibly on text alone. Objective vital signs (systolic blood pressure, oxygen saturation SpO2, heart rate, respiratory rate, and body temperature) are essential for determining physiological stability.
- **Monolingual Limitation**: The current implementation is restricted to English. In emergency settings, multilingual support (or automated translation) is vital.
- **Regulatory & Non-Medical Device Notice**: V-BETS is strictly an academic research prototype. It is not an FDA/CE-certified medical device and must never be utilized as a substitute for certified emergency medical dispatchers or clinical personnel.

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9. Conclusion

V-BETS demonstrates that a lightweight neural network (under 600 KB) combined with classical NLP lemmatization can provide real-time categorization of patient emergency descriptions. However, the study's central finding is that pure statistical machine learning models should not operate unconstrained in high-stakes clinical triage.

The final deployed model is Model v4, selected via an objective pre-registered rule, whose performance on an independent fresh test set (N=30, 10/10 RED recall, 95% CI [69.2%, 100.0%]) proved statistically indistinguishable from the earlier Model v2. In initial development on the original 45-sample evaluation set, pairing an empirical Bag-of-Words MLP with a deterministic red-flag safety net and low-confidence escalation logic similarly mitigated high-acuity under-triage failures, raising RED recall from 93.33% (14/15; 95% CI [68.05%, 99.83%]) to 100.00% (15/15; 95% CI [78.20%, 100.00%]). Across all evaluations, this hybrid architecture highlights a practical path forward for AI decision-support tools: statistical models provide flexible classification, while deterministic rule layers safeguard patient safety.